

INTERNATIONAL news

Infinion Technologies sells manufacturing sites to ASE

Infinion Technologies has sold two of its backend manufacturing sites in Cavite, Philippines, and Cheonan, South Korea, to Advanced Semiconductor Engineering (ASE). The move aligns with Infineon's strategy to balance in-house and external manufacturing. ASE will retain current employees and expand services at both sites, with long-term supply agreements ensuring Infineon's continued access to essential services. The transaction is expected to close by the end of Q2 2024.

\$1.5 billion funding to GlobalFoundries to boost US semiconductor industry

The Biden administration awarded \$1.5 billion to GlobalFoundries for its semiconductor facility expansion in New York, supported by the CHIPS and Science Act and New York Green CHIPS initiative. The expansion aims to triple Malta campus's capacity and increase Essex Junction site's gallium nitride semiconductor output, creating 1500 jobs.

Samsung could follow SK Hynix and adopt MUF chip manufacturing method

Samsung Electronics plans to adopt the mass reflow moulded underfill (MR-MUF) chip-making technology used by rival SK Hynix to boost high bandwidth memory (HBM) chip production for AI applications. Samsung, traditionally using non-conductive film (NCF) technology, aims to catch up in the AI chip race. The HBM chip market is expected to double to nearly \$9 billion this year, driven by AI demand.

amsOSRAM to halt Micro LED in Apple Watches, reevaluates strategy

amsOSRAM, a key supplier for Apple Watch, is reevaluating its Micro LED strategy due to potential high costs, leading to possible delays or cancellations in implementing Micro LED displays in future Apple Watches. The high cost of Micro LED technology, over twice as expensive as other Micro LED displays and thrice the cost of current OLED technology, poses a dilemma for its economic viability.

HP launches world's first quantum attack resistant PCs

HP announced the world's first business PCs designed to protect firmware against quantum computer attacks. These PCs feature an upgraded endpoint security controller (ESC) chip, offering security against the rising threat of quantum computer attacks. By isolating the chip from the processor and OS, ESC chip reduces the risk of data breaches and prevents downtime.

Infinion Technologies announces major sales organisation restructuring

Infinion Technologies AG is restructuring its sales organisation to drive growth and enhance customer focus. Effective from 1 March, the sales team will be organised into three segments: automotive, industrial & infrastructure, and consumer, computing & communication, while the distribution & ems (DEM) sales organisation will handle distributors and electronics manufacturing services (EMS).

Applied Ventures invests in VVDN technologies

Applied Ventures, LLC, the venture capital arm of Applied Materials, Inc., has made a growth equity investment in VVDN Technologies, an India-based electronics product design, software, and manufacturing company. This funding will enable VVDN to expand its R&D in next-generation semiconductor technologies and electronic products.

Sony to collaborate with Seagate for HDDs

Sony is collaborating with Seagate Technology, a US-based company, to ramp up the production of hard disk drives (HDDs)



Representational image

in response to the growing demand for AI. Sony Semiconductor Solutions is expected to start mass-producing lasers used in these drives in May and plans to invest about 5 billion yen (\$33 million) in new production lines.

Huawei launches Intelligent Distribution, reduces high line losses

Huawei has unveiled its Intelligent Distribution Solution (IDS) to address challenges in the electric power industry such as high line losses, unreliable service, and managing new energy loads. The solution incorporates an on-premises private cloud, wired and wireless backhaul network solutions, and an innovative edge computing unit (ECU). A key feature is the use of next-generation high-speed power line carrier communication (HPLC) technology for low-voltage communication, facilitating rapid data collection and achieving a 99% data acquisition success rate.

GM, Magna, and Wipro team up to develop B2B automotive software sales platform

General Motors, Magna, and Wipro Limited have collaborated to create SDVerse, a B2B sales platform for the automotive industry, aimed at transforming the way automotive software is bought and sold. The digital marketplace will facilitate a more transparent and efficient connection between buyers and sellers, allowing for direct transactions of embedded automotive software. Prashant Gulati has been appointed as the CEO, bringing over twenty years of experience in the automotive industry.

LONGi signs long-term silicon supply agreement with Ferroglobe

LONGi, a solar technology company, has entered into a long-term supply agreement with Ferroglobe PLC, a producer of silicon metal and ferro alloys, starting January 1, 2024. Ferroglobe will supply high-quality quartzite and metallurgical grade silicon (MGS) to LONGi, supporting its strategy to increase purchases from leading Western suppliers of silicon materials.

Lenovo introduces certified refurbished products initiative

Lenovo has launched the 'Certified Refurbished Products' initiative to offer affordable technology by selling refurbished computers and other hardware. The initiative aims to address electronic waste, starting as a pilot in Denmark, France, Germany, the United Kingdom, and Hong Kong. Devices sold through this initiative will undergo comprehensive data cleansing and maintenance, ensuring their good condition.